

英検準1級 リーディング問題

2026年度 第1回

氏名 _____ 実施日 _____



ReadPassで復習

解答方法 各問について、最も適切なものを1つ選び、問題冊子の選択肢に○を付けてください。

正解は最終ページにあります。すべて解いてから確認してください。

大問1 語彙・文法 Q1-Q4

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(1) In order to illustrate how a cell functions, the biology teacher drew a detailed (1) on the board showing all of its parts.

1 cemetery 2 diagram 3 equation 4 forecast

(2) **A:** I think this sentence in your essay is (2).
B: Oh, you're right. It's almost the same as what I said in the previous paragraph.

1 possessive 2 horizontal 3 redundant 4 drastic

(3) In some countries, governments (3) the media in order to prevent criticism of them from being published.

1 haul 2 envy 3 subtract 4 censor

(4) The scholarship is only available to students who meet its requirements. A (4) must have excellent grades and be from a low-income background.

1 referral 2 recipient 3 bouncer 4 successor

大問1 語彙・文法 Q5-Q9

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (5) The scientist was accused of (5) his data after experts attempted to copy his experiments but were unable to produce the same results.
1 triggering 2 fabricating 3 conserving 4 renouncing
- (6) Last week, a police officer stopped Javier and gave him a traffic (6) for driving faster than the speed limit.
1 ransom 2 specimen 3 cavity 4 citation
- (7) Because some (7) was expected, the captain turned on the seat belt sign and asked all the passengers to return to their seats.
1 distortion 2 generosity 3 turbulence 4 conjecture
- (8) After several years with almost no rain, the area became a (8) wasteland where no trees or other plants could survive.
1 nutritious 2 diverse 3 barren 4 coincidental
- (9) When Simon pulled on the rope, it suddenly became (9). He realized that it must have come untied at the other end.
1 slack 2 sparse 3 vast 4 vital

大問1 語彙・文法 Q10-Q14

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(10) The patient was diagnosed with a vitamin (10). The doctor said she would need to take supplements until her vitamin levels were normal again.

- 1 descendant 2 triumph 3 emission 4 deficiency

(11) Tanya seemed shy and nervous when she entered her new school, but she is now (11) socially and has made a lot of friends.

- 1 flourishing 2 pledging 3 scattering 4 drooping

(12) The art student showed her (12) to the gallery owner. It contained samples of her paintings, drawings, and photographs.

- 1 reptile 2 glacier 3 blockade 4 portfolio

(13) The teacher asked the student to (13) his essay. She said it should be about half the length it was.

- 1 abbreviate 2 attest 3 carve 4 yield

(14) The patient was in so much pain that the dentist had no choice but to (14) the patient's damaged tooth.

- 1 radiate 2 magnify 3 extract 4 impart

大問1 語彙・文法 Q15-Q18

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(15) The company was badly affected by the financial crisis and nearly (15), but it has now recovered and is making a profit again.

- 1 sank in 2 let out 3 went under 4 lived off

(16) The police officer became suspicious of the man because his story did not (16). He was later found to have lied to the police.

- 1 add up 2 read into 3 take off 4 fall out

(17) The patient tried to (17) from the hospital without anyone noticing, but the nurse saw him and stopped him.

- 1 slip away 2 tear up 3 drop out 4 follow up

(18) **A:** Our meeting prep took longer than expected.
B: Yeah, the budget review really (18) most of our afternoon.

- 1 fed off 2 burnt out 3 fell through 4 ate up

大問2A 長文の語句空所補充 Q19-Q21

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(19)から(24)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Birth Order

The idea that the order in which children are born can have a lasting and dramatic effect on their personalities was developed by the Austrian psychologist Alfred Adler more than a century ago. (19), Adler believed that firstborns tended to be responsible yet anxious, that middle children were more diplomatic, and that youngest siblings were more rebellious. Today, the theory is featured in many parenting books.

Extensive research has been conducted on birth order. One notable study, for example, examined thousands of teenagers and found that it did lead to some measurable differences. Eldest siblings, for instance, differed from others in terms of things like responsibility and anxiety. However, while firstborns were, as expected, found to be more responsible, they tended to be less anxious, which did not fit the stereotype. In addition to such contradictions, the differences for every birth position were extremely slight. According to the researchers, associations between birth order and a person’s character (20).

As children grow, there are obvious differences in everything from maturity to rebelliousness. Parents often observe that younger children have less self-control and disobey them more than older children. However, it is also true that this (21). It therefore seems that what many people take to be birth order affecting personality is really just the temporary stages of development their children are going through. Personality, experts tell us, is determined more by things like genetics and one’s living environment than it is by the order in which children were born.

(19)

- 1
- Consequently
- 2
- Specifically
- 3
- Nonetheless
- 4
- Otherwise

(20)

- 1
- have less effect on youngest siblings
- 2
- become stronger as children age
- 3
- are mostly meaningless
- 4
- should be more widely accepted

(21)

- 1
- tends to fade with time
- 2
- is related mainly to intelligence
- 3
- affects their success as adults
- 4
- is due to parenting styles

大問2B 長文の語句空所補充 Q22-Q24

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(19)から(24)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Digital Nations

The small Polynesian island nation of Tuvalu is in danger of disappearing forever. Scientists have predicted that, decades from now, living in Tuvalu will become impossible due to rising sea levels caused by climate change. When that happens, the only option for Tuvaluans will be to move elsewhere. (22), the preparations for doing this are already in place. Tuvalu has negotiated an agreement with Australia that allows a certain number of its people to emigrate there every year.

Tuvalu's government is doing what it can to save its nation. Sea barriers have been built, and work is underway to create an area of raised land that will provide a habitable area for residents. However, the government knows these measures may be useless in the long term. So, it (23). A few years ago, it set up the Future Now Project. Part of this project involves creating a virtual reconstruction of the nation. Along with preserving geographical features, the project aims to create a digital record of Tuvalu's people and customs.

Some critics claim the resources required for the project could be better used to tackle climate change. In response, Tuvalu's government points out that the project (24). The current international treaty states that sovereign nations must have a "defined territory" and a "permanent population." Tuvalu's government hopes to pioneer a new form of statehood that allows it to continue to exist by meeting these criteria in a virtual form. This could also help to ensure the survival of other island nations facing similar threats from the sea.

(22)

- 1 On the contrary 2 Despite this 3 Similarly 4 In fact

(23)

- 1 is turning to technology instead 2 is planning to construct stronger defenses 3 has stopped all current projects 4 has requested help from other nations

(24)

- 1 is no longer necessary 2 should not take long to complete 3 will not only benefit Tuvalu 4 has no clear purpose

大問3A 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ25-Q27に答えなさい。

Uruk

The ancient settlement of Uruk was located in a fertile delta between the Tigris and Euphrates rivers in the region of Sumer, in what is now southern Iraq. Uruk began life as a village. However, toward the end of the fourth millennium BC, it had developed to such an extent that some historians consider it the world's first city. Behind this remarkable growth were several factors, including technological advancements that increased agricultural efficiency, such as the construction of irrigation canals to funnel water to fields and orchards. These advances not only allowed Uruk to support a growing population but also to create a surplus, which could then be traded. Expansion continued, and by the third millennium BC, Uruk was thriving as a Sumerian cultural and religious center, a military power, and the hub of a trade network.

As Uruk grew, it helped shape the political and cultural landscape of the Sumer region, influencing other cities that developed around the same period. Various other developments helped Uruk evolve into the sophisticated city it became, including its early use of cuneiform script. The script was mainly written on clay tablets, many of which survive to this day. In its early form, it was relatively simple, with pictures representing goods, but it allowed for rudimentary recordkeeping. The writing system gradually became more sophisticated and was used for accounting and general administrative matters, which helped facilitate the governance of the increasingly complex city. Over time, the script was used in the Sumer region to keep records in fields such as economics, politics, and religion.

However, Uruk's dominant position was not to last forever. Uruk had competed with neighboring Sumerian cities for hundreds of years, leaving them all vulnerable to forces from other regions. In the latter half of the third millennium BC, the Akkadians conquered much of Sumer. Despite this conquest, Uruk's religious districts were respected and protected, and after Akkadian rule came to an end, a renaissance of Sumerian culture occurred. Although later conflicts and invasions meant that Uruk would not return to its earlier heights, it remained an important city for many centuries to come. Archaeological excavations have revealed an immense city wall, sculptures, artworks, large stone buildings decorated with mosaics, and numerous pyramid-like structures called ziggurats that were topped with temples-all of which point to the historical significance of Uruk.

大問3A 長文設問 Q25-Q27

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (25) What does the author of the passage say about Uruk's development?
- 1 Rapid progress would have been possible even without the technological advances that increased agricultural efficiency.
 - 2 One important characteristic was its ability to produce more food than it needed, which allowed for more rapid change to occur.
 - 3 The construction of canals for agricultural use could not keep up with the needs of a growing population.
 - 4 It lost out on the most profitable trade deals because it reserved too much of its crop harvests for its own population.
-
- (26) What is one thing we learn about the cuneiform script?
- 1 The benefits its use provided were not enough to enable Uruk to stay ahead of rival cities.
 - 2 Although it had uses that aided development in Uruk, it was less suited to complex bureaucratic tasks.
 - 3 It was first developed for religious purposes but was later adopted for use in commerce and government.
 - 4 It provided Uruk with a means to help manage the administration of its increasingly complex society.
-
- (27) Which of the following statements is true, based on the final paragraph?
- 1 Even though the Sumer region was attacked and defeated by outside forces, the religious heritage of Uruk was not destroyed.
 - 2 Uruk borrowed some of its religious architecture and artistic techniques from neighboring cities in Sumer.
 - 3 The Akkadians had to destroy much of the wall and stone buildings in order to defeat Uruk.
 - 4 Uruk's decline can be attributed to the fact that neighboring Sumerian cities created alliances with the Akkadians.
-

大問3B 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ28-Q31に答えなさい。

Animal Uplift

While the concept of artificially increasing animal intelligence through technology once seemed like science fiction, recent advances suggest it may be achievable. One promising approach for doing so is genetic manipulation. For instance, in 2014, researchers discovered that a human gene called FOXP2 was related to acquiring language skills in humans. When mice were genetically altered to produce it, they were able to learn a route through a maze much more rapidly than their unmodified counterparts, indicating that the gene had significantly enhanced their memory, which is an essential component of intelligence. This research is preliminary, however, and intelligence depends on a multitude of genes, so significant technical and ethical hurdles must be overcome before such advancements can be responsibly applied.

An aspect of animal uplift that needs to be considered is the possibility of unintended outcomes. One experiment compared fish with larger brains that were bred together to fish with smaller brains that were bred together. The young of the larger-brained fish tended to have even bigger brains, and the babies' performance on cognitive tests was superior to that of fish with smaller brains. However, the researchers also observed that these fish produced young that had smaller digestive systems, and this in turn seems to have led them to produce fewer offspring. This is likely due to the fact that larger brains require substantially more energy. As this experiment indicates, trying to boost intelligence may disrupt other physical attributes, leading to consequences that extend beyond the individual animals to entire populations.

Furthermore, opponents of animal uplift point out that the process would likely involve surgical procedures on healthy animals. There would almost certainly be psychological consequences as well, and an uplifted animal's existence might well be completely transformed. A mouse, whose life would normally be a simple matter of survival, could instead be thrust into a confusing, possibly terrifying awareness of how brief its lifespan is and how little control it has over its environment. There is also the issue of whether making such radical alterations to an animal's biology could ever be considered ethical, since it would be impossible for the creature to give consent beforehand, especially since the procedures would probably not be reversible.

George Dvorsky, chairperson of the Institute for Ethics and Emerging Technologies, however, argues that withholding animal uplift is itself unethical. Animals have long been sacrificed as test subjects during the creation of new surgical procedures or the development of medicines that have increased human life expectancy, and if humans artificially increase our own intelligence, animals will likely be sacrificed for that as well. According to Dvorsky, in light of increased awareness of animal rights and given the tremendous role that animals have played in improving human existence, withholding advances that could improve their intelligence would be just as unethical as withholding them from a group of humans who lack sufficient wealth to afford them. While the ability to uplift animals would have undeniable benefits, it is also true that we face an ethical dilemma when altering another species. Clearly, there are difficult decisions about animal uplift that need to be made.

大問3B 長文設問 Q28-Q31

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (28) What is one thing that we learn about the research into the FOXP2 gene?
- 1 Since it only had a minor effect on the mice's memory, it cannot really be said to have improved their overall intelligence.
 - 2 Although it affected one element of the mice's intelligence, it is just an early step in what will most likely be a complicated process.
 - 3 It demonstrated that the way that mice communicated with each other was more sophisticated than had previously been believed.
 - 4 It indicates that mice may actually have a form of intelligence that researchers were not aware of in the past.
-
- (29) What does the fish experiment indicate about attempts at animal uplift?
- 1 There are limits to how intelligent animals can become, and no amount of breeding will ever be able to overcome them.
 - 2 It is possible that an attempt to increase animal intelligence will actually have the opposite of its intended effect.
 - 3 Attempts to increase an animal's intelligence could interfere with other important aspects of the animal's biology.
 - 4 While it is possible to slightly increase animal intelligence, it is not likely that it will be inherited by an animal's offspring.
-
- (30) One argument against animal uplift that is presented in the third paragraph is that
- 1 it should not be carried out because it is impossible for animals to agree to what is going to happen to them.
 - 2 it could bring about significant changes in animal behavior that could, in turn, have negative effects on the environment.
 - 3 there are likely to be more risks in performing operations on animals' brains due to our lack of knowledge about how they function.
 - 4 there is a significant risk that the effects of the procedure could reduce the survival instincts of animals that receive it.
-
- (31) What does George Dvorsky believe about animal uplift?
- 1 Humans need to develop better types of surgical procedures so that we do not harm animals when trying to uplift them.
 - 2 It is likely that the same medical advances that are used to uplift animals will also help them to live longer, healthier lives.
 - 3 Humans should develop the technology necessary for uplifting animals before we consider whether it is right to do so or not.
 - 4 If humans use animals in the process of increasing our own intelligence, that would increase our obligation to uplift them.
-

正解一覧

すべて解き終えてから確認してください。 大問3は正解番号のみを表示しています。



Q01-Q11		Q12-Q21		Q22-Q31	
Q01	2	Q12	4	Q22	4
diagram		portfolio		In fact	
Q02	3	Q13	1	Q23	1
redundant		abbreviate		is turning to technology instead	
Q03	4	Q14	3	Q24	3
censor		extract		will not only benefit Tuvalu	
Q04	2	Q15	3	Q25	2
recipient		went under			
Q05	2	Q16	1	Q26	4
fabricating		add up			
Q06	4	Q17	1	Q27	1
citation		slip away			
Q07	3	Q18	4	Q28	2
turbulence		ate up			
Q08	3	Q19	2	Q29	3
barren		Specifically			
Q09	1	Q20	3	Q30	1
slack		are mostly meaningless			
Q10	4	Q21	1	Q31	4
deficiency		tends to fade with time			
Q11	1				
flourishing					

学習記録	得点	_____ / 31	やり直す問題	_____
	メモ	_____		_____